

Kodak EasyShare M575

Features

- Resolution: 14 MP
- Optical zoom: 5x
- LCD: 7.6 cm (3 inches)
- HD video recording: Yes

Price
₹999



images due to camera shake (due to unsteady hands) while shooting. Optical lens-shift image stabilisation detects a wide range of vibrations, from low to high frequencies, and corrects accordingly. This image stabilising technology, based on Canon's proprietary lens-shift image stabilising system, shifts the correcting lens element in parallel to the image plane to correct the optical axis in response to image shake.

"Some cameras do the correction electronically; after taking the picture, the camera modifies it electronically – so natural details are lost. With optical image stabilisation, on the other hand, the picture is clearer and more natural," says Shunichi Senda, Director-ICP, Canon India.

LCD. Having perfected features like resolution and zoom, manufacturers are now focusing on the LCD screen for improvement. Three factors have to be considered in the LCD: size, viewing angle and number of dots. All these will help you view better picture contrast and exact colour of the captured image.

LCD screen size of 6.9 to 7.6 cm (2.7 to 3 inches) is standard, and 8.9 cm (3.5 inches) is starting to become popular. But, a size above 8.9 cm is not practical as the camera too would become bigger. Also, the bigger the screen, the more the battery consumption.

Go for a touchscreen if you are ready to pay extra.

Wide angle. Wide angle is must-have in a camera. It helps especially in indoor photography to cover wider area, and in outdoor photography to cover a wide scene. Most of the upcoming models of cameras incorporate 28mm or 24mm lenses.

Low-light performance. Highly sensitive CMOS sensors let you take excellent shots even in minimal lighting conditions such as twilight. These also keep the noise to a minimal level.

Sweep Panorama technology. To take breathtaking shots of large landscapes, like a never-ending horizon or mountain ranges, go for Sweep Panorama technology. This technology allows you to sweep your camera across the landscape for up to 224 degrees and gives you a picture that otherwise would never have come in a single shot. You simply swing the camera steadily in the desired direction to create stunning landscapes and cityscapes, including vertical shots of tall buildings.

Double anti-blur solution. Combining high sensitivity and optical steadysight, the double anti-blur solution significantly reduces motion blurs, allowing you to capture sharp images even in difficult situations.

HD capability. High-definition capability gives superior-quality videos. This feature is preferred but make sure you have an HD-compatible TV or computer at home to view these videos. If your TV is not HD-capable, you will not be able to take benefit of

this costly feature.

You can record video in high-definition and then watch your HD movies on your HDTV set via the camera's HDMI connector. But a lot of cameras with HD video don't come with an HDMI connector. So make sure that the model you select has one.

Kodak M580 comes with an HDMI connector, so you can connect the camera to the LCD TV and watch HD video.

Checklist for handycams

Format. The choice of format, whether hard disk (HD) or flash memory (SD card), depends on your usage requirements.

With flash memory, data is safe and doesn't collapse.

HD camcorders, on the other hand, are more versatile and more convenient. If you are going to record HD videos very frequently, an HD camcorder like Sony's HDR-XR550E or HDR-XR150E Handycam might be the perfect choice for you. Otherwise, even a Flash-memory camcorder is sufficient for day-to-day use.

Storage capacity. Memory space is the most important factor in a camcorder. Choose the storage capacity based on your usage and storage needs.

Resolution. HD camcorders give out much cleaner, crisper and detailed videos and images than non-HD ones.

Optical zoom. As mentioned earlier, a crucial factor that differentiates a camcorder from a digicam is zooming. Zooming (optical) capabilities of Sony handycams range from 10x to 60x based on the model.

Sound recording. Don't forget to check sound recording capability of

Canon IXUS 105

Features

- Resolution: 12.1 MP
- Optical zoom: 4x
- LCD: 6.8 cm (2.7 inches)

Price
₹995

